Digital and GenAI Adoption Support for SMEs (IMDA / DISG / EnterpriseSG) — SMF Advisory Note

Internal advisory note for SMF member-facing officers. Not legal or financial advice.

> ***ACCURACY WARNING FOR THIS NOTE.*** *During compilation,* ***imda.gov.sg could not be accessed****, and* ***gobusiness.gov.sg serves no readable content to automated retrieval****. Everything in this note that is IMDA-owned is therefore* ***unverified*** *and marked accordingly. The two initiatives documented with full confidence below (Enterprise Compute Initiative, Champions of AI) are administered by* ***DISG and EnterpriseSG, not IMDA****. Officers must check imda.gov.sg directly before quoting any IMDA figure.*

Overview

Digital and AI adoption support for Singapore SMEs is currently spread across at least three agencies:

- **IMDA** — SMEs Go Digital, Industry Digital Plans, Digital Leaders Programme, CTO-as-a-Service, and (historically) the GenAI Sandbox for SMEs.
- **EnterpriseSG** — PSG-funded pre-approved digital and GenAI solutions; the Champions of AI Programme.
- **DISG (Digital Industry Singapore)** — the Enterprise Compute Initiative.

For an SMF manufacturing member asking "how do I get help adopting AI", the practical routing in mid-2026 is: **small, off-the-shelf tools → PSG; a real custom AI build with an in-house tech team → Enterprise Compute Initiative; strategic end-to-end AI transformation → Champions of AI (pilot).**

What It Funds

Enterprise Compute Initiative (ECI) — LIVE and open *(fully verified)*

Announced at **Budget 2025** with **up to S$150 million** set aside by the Ministry of Finance. **Administered by DISG (Digital Industry Singapore)**, contact `ECI_DISG@edb.gov.sg`.

What it funds: (i) cloud credits and AI tools from partner Cloud Service Providers; and (ii) consultancy to build a minimum viable product plus change management.

Support level: *"total supportable consulting cost is capped at S$150,000, with DISG supporting 70% of actual costs, capped at S$105,000 per company."* The company pays the remaining 30%.

Duration: approximately **6 months** per company; the programme runs for one year from each CSP's launch date, in rolling cohorts.

CSP partners and published credit ceilings:

- Google Cloud — up to **S$200,000** in training licences
- AWS — **S$350,000** AI Springboard credits plus up to **S$600,000** complementary
- Microsoft — up to **S$250,000** Azure credits plus up to **S$700,000** in services
- Oracle — up to **S$250,000** credits plus up to **S$1.9 million** for private cloud infrastructure

Eligibility: registered/incorporated and physically present in Singapore; CEO-level sponsorship; **Singapore headcount of at least 10**; **an in-house tech team of at least 2** (software/AI engineers, data scientists); prior experience building a custom AI solution (proof-of-concept or deployment); accessible datasets; financial ability to co-fund. **Subcontracting to meet the headcount requirement is explicitly not allowed.** All sectors except gambling/betting.

How to apply: https://www.disg.gov.sg/apply-here/ → https://form.gov.sg/67ef9a05e8b901fcefbe1433 . Corppass plus audited financials required. Applicants notified within **4 weeks**.

Pitfall for SMF members: the "at least 2 in-house software/AI engineers" and "prior custom AI experience" bars exclude most small manufacturers. Screen for this before recommending ECI — it is aimed at digitally mature

firms, not first-time adopters.

Source: https://www.disg.gov.sg/enterprise-compute-initiative/ (page footer: "Last Updated 19 Jun 2026"); factsheet https://www.disg.gov.sg/files/ECI_Factsheet_10_Feb.pdf ("Updated as of 10 Feb 2026"); https://www.disg.gov.sg/cloud-service-providers/ ; pilot: https://www.disg.gov.sg/eci-pilot/

Champions of AI Programme — LIVE (pilot phase) *(verified)*

"A flagship national initiative by Enterprise Singapore (EnterpriseSG) and Digital Industry Singapore (DISG)" for end-to-end enterprise AI transformation. EnterpriseSG states it will "pilot with a few companies to start, and expand over time."

Funding figures: TO VERIFY — none published on the programme page. Register interest: https://form.gov.sg/69b370fda67b90e33c25594d Source: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/boost-capabilities/growth-and-transformation/champions-of-ai-programme

GenAI and AI-enabled solutions via PSG — LIVE *(verified as a routing, not as a figure)*

EnterpriseSG's Productivity & Digitalisation hub carries cards reading **"GenAI Solutions for SMEs — Tap on a range of GenAI solutions through the Productivity Solutions Grant"** and **"AI-enabled solutions for SMEs — Tap on a range of GenAI and AI-enabled solutions through the Productivity Solutions Grant."** PSG's standard terms apply: up to 50% of eligible costs for local SMEs, with a stated S$30,000 figure (see `grant_psg.md`).

Other AI programmes currently listed by EnterpriseSG

Driving Entrepreneurship with AI Workshops; Applied AI Programme at Singapore Polytechnic; Applied AI Programme at Nanyang Polytechnic; Google for Startups Accelerator: AI First; The Ignition AI Accelerator (NVIDIA + Tribe); **Spark GenAI** (DBS, *"in partnership with Enterprise Singapore (EnterpriseSG) and the Infocomm Media Development Authority (IMDA)"*, whose "Adopt" pillar offers *"access to grants provided by IMDA and EnterpriseSG"* — direct evidence that IMDA still runs SME digitalisation grants in mid-2026, though no figures are published there). Source: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/boost-capabilities/productivity-and-digitalisation

Items That Could NOT Be Verified — Do Not Quote

Item	Status	Note
SMEs Go Digital	**TO VERIFY**	Programme status, current scope and structure not retrievable. imda.gov.sg inaccessible.
Industry Digital Plans (IDPs), incl. any **Manufacturing IDP**	**TO VERIFY**	Sector list and URLs not retrievable. Do not assert a Manufacturing IDP exists.
Digital Leaders Programme (DLP)	**UNCONFIRMED**	Card still live on EnterpriseSG's hub ("Develop innovative business models and capture new growth opportunities with this digital integration approach") linking to https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/boost-capabilities/productivity-and-digitalisation/digital-leaders-programme , but the page returns an empty body. Funding quantum, cap, eligibility and route all **TO VERIFY**.
CTO-as-a-Service	**TO VERIFY**	Not retrievable.

Item	Status	Note
GenAI Sandbox for SMEs	**UNCONFIRMED — likely superseded**	The EnterpriseSG card whose image file is still named `genai-sandbox-for-smes.png` is now titled **"GenAI Solutions for SMEs"** and points to PSG. This strongly suggests the standalone sandbox has been folded into PSG-funded pre-approved GenAI solutions, but **no closure date, tranche count, per-SME cap or subsidy rate could be confirmed. Do not state that it is closed, and do not quote its old figures.**
Advanced Digital Solutions (ADS)	**TO VERIFY**	Cannot state LIVE or CLOSED. https://www.gobusiness.gov.sg/smesgodigital/advanced-digital-solutions resolves but returns zero content.
National AI Strategy 2.0 / AI Singapore / Budget 2026 AI measures	**TO VERIFY**	Source domains inaccessible. ECI documentation does state ECI contributes to *"the broader goal stated in the National AI Strategy 2.0 of anchoring AI teams across Singapore."*

How to Apply (summary)

- **ECI:** https://www.disg.gov.sg/apply-here/ (FormSG, Corppass, audited financials)
- **Champions of AI:** register interest at https://form.gov.sg/69b370fda67b90e33c25594d
- **PSG-funded GenAI/AI solutions:** Business Grants Portal, apply.gov.sg/grants/business, after selecting a solution from the GoBusiness catalogue
- **IMDA programmes:** check https://www.imda.gov.sg directly — this note cannot be relied upon for IMDA scheme mechanics

Common Pitfalls

- **Recommending ECI to a small manufacturer.** The ≥10 Singapore headcount, ≥2 in-house AI/software engineers and prior-custom-AI-build requirements screen out most SMF SMEs.
- **Assuming the GenAI Sandbox is still open in its original form.** It appears to have been re-routed through PSG. Verify before telling a member.
- **Confusing the CSP credit ceilings with the grant.** The S$200k/S$350k/S$250k figures are **CSP-provided credits and services**, not government cash grants. The government's cash support under ECI is the **70% of consulting cost, capped at S$105,000**.
- **Double-funding.** A GenAI tool funded under PSG cannot also be claimed under another scheme for the same cost.
- **Quoting IMDA figures from memory or from third-party blog posts.** Several IMDA digitalisation schemes have been restructured; only imda.gov.sg is authoritative.

Source & Last Verified

- https://www.disg.gov.sg/enterprise-compute-initiative/ (Last Updated 19 Jun 2026)
- https://www.disg.gov.sg/files/ECI_Factsheet_10_Feb.pdf (Updated as of 10 Feb 2026)
- https://www.disg.gov.sg/cloud-service-providers/ , https://www.disg.gov.sg/apply-here/ , https://www.disg.gov.sg/eci-pilot/
- https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/boost-capabilities/growth-and-transformation/champions-of-ai-programme
- https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/boost-capabilities/productivity-and-digitalisation

- https://www.dbs.com.sg/sme/dbs-forms/sparkgenai/interest-form
- **Could not be accessed:** imda.gov.sg (all paths), gobusiness.gov.sg (returns no content to automated retrieval), aisingapore.org, smartnation.gov.sg, mddi.gov.sg, edb.gov.sg
- **Last verified: 26 July 2026.**